

RULE: كان = was. Its sisters include صار مازال ليس. After them, predicate takes FATHA (accusative).

Arabic	Meaning	Example
كان	was	كان رجلا صالحا = He was a righteous man
صار	became	صار عالما = He became a scholar
أصبح	became (morning)	أصبح غنيا = He became rich
مازال	still is	مازال صادقا = He is still truthful
ليس	is not	ليس عالما = He is not a scholar

☐ Predicate of كان = fatha: كان مدرسا (not مدرس)

☐ كان الله غفورا رحيمًا (timeless divine attribute = Allah is Ever-Forgiving, Ever-Merciful)

☐ ما زال = very useful = still is/was: ما زلت أتعلم = I am still learning